

Need a Backend For Your App? Here's Parse to the Rescue!

Discover Parse, which allows mobile app developers to forget about server maintenance and complex infrastructure, and instantly add push notifications, data storage and social integration to their apps. Read on...

With the advent of technologies that support mobile development, local storage on browsers, etc, most of the applications developed today are not database intensive, i.e., they do not save much data in the databases. All they need is limited information like user details, high scores, or other such data that cannot be stored on the client side. So when the application is more intensive on the client front and there's minimal data to store, would a developer want to invest in the middleware and backend technologies? The answer is a simple 'no'. But what do the developers do, then? Does their dream mobile application go down the drain? No, since MBaaS comes to the rescue. With the dawn of cloud technology, developers have been blessed with a technology called Mobile Backend as a Service (MBaaS). While taking care of the middleware and backend, it lets developers nurture their dreams and focus entirely on the app. Wikipedia defines MBaaS as: "Backend as a service (BaaS), also known as 'mobile backend as a service' (Mbaas), is a model for providing Web and mobile app developers with a way to link their applications to backend cloud storage, while also providing features such as user management, push notifications and integration with social networking services."

There are many such MBaaS providers in the market with various offerings. But making the right choice is the biggest challenge. With every list, there are the pros and cons. Today, let's get to know one major player in the MBaaS market – Parse. I'll share my thoughts and opinions about it, and also provide a few snippets to get you started. It's as wonderful as it sounds. With ease of use for every kind

of developer—Web or mobile (hybrid or native)—it provides a wonderful interface and an even more wonderful API to take care of your backend and middleware needs.

Why Parse?

With so many players in the MBaaS arena, why would a developer opt for Parse? With a simplistic API, Parse also offers many other perks to the developers.

The biggest concern for any developer regarding their backend connectivity is the number of hits. The developer always tries to minimise the number of hits to the server so as to reduce the server load. But for a client-side intensive application, there is only a need to hit the server maybe once or twice in a day, for instance, to update user stats, or the leaderboard, etc.

With Parse's 'Basic' plan, a developer gets one million requests per account, per month. To juxtapose these figures into a more realistic scenario, let's assume your app has 10,000 daily users. With one million requests per month, you can cater to approximately 3.3 requests per user, per day—and that too, for free! You don't have to worry about writing Web services, maintaining a database, or pay for hosting. And if you are developing a mobile

